

TCH Works

Fridge-First Meal System

Clear what you own · plan 7 dinners · one shop

Deeper than a blank meal grid. Fridge ritual + filled UK examples.

Soft Stripe · Instant PDF · Not advice

Page 1 · Fridge clear ritual (15 min)

Open the fridge before you write a single dinner. Use what you already paid for.

- Pull everything forward — nothing hiding at the back
- Bin / compost what is past it (be honest)
- Move “eat this week” to a front shelf or clear box
- List proteins you already have
- List veg / leftovers that must go first
- Note milk / bread / staples that are actually low

Eat-first list (what must be cooked this week)

Filled example: half roast chicken · spinach wilting · two peppers · leftover chilli · yoghurt open

Staples actually low

Page 2 · Seven dinners (fridge-first)

Fill dinners from the eat-first list. Leave one night for leftovers. Keep two “under 30” school nights.

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun

Row tips: dinner name · main fridge item used · rough minutes

Filled example: Mon chicken fried rice (leftover roast, 25) · Tue pasta + spinach (15) · Wed leftover night · Thu traybake sausages+peppers (30) · Fri fish fingers+peas · Sat chilli reload · Sun roast batch

Leftover night (which day + what)

Page 3 · Leftover night + snack strip

Leftover night rules

- Pick the day with least after-school rush
- Reheat safely — label the box on cook day
- If nothing left, fallback: eggs on toast / beans / omelette — still counts

This week's leftover plan

Filled example: Wed — chilli bowls + rice from Sat batch. Fallback: cheese toasties.

Snack strip (fridge / fruit bowl — not a second shop)

- Fruit that will go first
- Yoghurt / cheese sticks already in
- Something crunchy already owned
- One “treat drawer” rule so you are not renegotiating nightly

Page 4 · Aisle grocery (only the gaps)

Shop last. Only buy what the dinner grid still needs after fridge clear.

Aisle	Need (from grid gaps)	Qty	Got
Fruit & veg			
Meat / fish / alt			
Dairy & eggs			
Bakery			
Cupboard / tins			
Frozen			
Other			

Filled example: peppers ×2 · spinach bag · sausages 8 · milk · pitta · frozen peas — nothing else.

Soft note: planning tool only — not nutrition or medical advice. Skip any page that does not fit your household.

Page 5 · Weekly repeat log

Reuse every week. Date the run. Note waste you still bought so next fridge clear gets sharper.

Date	Fridge clear?	Leftover night	Waste bought anyway	Note

Soft ladder: free Meal Grid → this system £9.99 → Grocery List £4.99 add-on · Meal Planner £12.99
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